UNIT
3

p-BLOCK ELEMENTS - II



Sir William Ramsay,
(1852 – 1916)

Sir William Ramsay was a Scottish chemist who discovered the noble gases. During the years 1885–1890 he published several important papers on the oxides of nitrogen.In August 1894, Ramsay had isolated a new heavy element of air, and he named it "argon", (the Greek word meaning "lazy").In the following years, he worked with Morris Travers and discovered neon, krypton, and xenon. In 1910 he isolated and characterized radon. In recognition of his services in the discovery of the inert gases, he was awarded a noble prize in chemistry in 1904. His work in isolating noble gases led to the development of a new section of the periodic table.

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Learning Objectives

After studying this unit, the students will be able to

- discuss the preparation and properties of important compounds of nitrogen and phosphorus
- describe the preparation and properties of important compounds of oxygen and sulphur
- describe the preparation, properties of halogens and hydrogen halides
- explain the chemistry of inter-halogen compounds
- describe the occurrence, properties and uses of noble gases
- appreciate the importance of p-block elements and their compounds in day today life.

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